

Monthly household spending indicator: Steady print amid softer signals

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February household spending indicator: 0.3%_{mth}, 4.6%_{yr}



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Household spending rose 0.3%_{mth} in February, matching January's outcome and in line with its

average monthly pace over the past two years. Annual growth edged up to 4.6%yr.

Services continued to drive overall growth, rising 0.5%*mt*, supported by holiday-related spending across recreation & culture, transport and accommodation. Goods spending reversed recent weakness to post a modest 0.1%*mt* gain.

State outcomes were mixed. WA led the gains, with SA, Qld and Vic also recording increases. NSW was the only state to post a decline.

Looking ahead, risks to the spending outlook remain skewed to the downside. Weaker consumer sentiment, ongoing monetary policy restraint and signals from our Westpac–DataX Card Tracker suggest spending growth is likely to moderate over coming months.

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